Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Maintaining the Retail Sales Record & Dashboard

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Applies To	Retail Sales Record (Excel) and companion Power BI dashboard
Review Cycle	Monthly
Version	1.0

1. Purpose

This SOP sets out the standard process for collecting, cleaning, updating, and reporting on retail sales data held in the Retail Sales Record. It ensures the data stays accurate and consistent, and that the Excel pivots and the Power BI dashboard can be refreshed reliably each reporting cycle.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to the ongoing maintenance of the raw sales log, the cleaned data tab, the pivot summaries (Region, Category, Channel), the monthly trend and forecast, and the Power BI dashboard built from this data.

3. Data Collection

1. Record each new sale in the raw data log as soon as the transaction is completed, using the standard column structure (Order ID, Order Date, Customer Name, Region, City, Product Category, Product, Quantity, Unit Price, Discount %, Total Sales, Shipping Cost, Sales Channel, Sales Rep, Payment Method, Order Status).

2. Use a unique, sequential Order ID for every transaction, never reuse an ID.

3. Enter Quantity, Unit Price, and Discount % at the point of sale so Total Sales can be calculated correctly from the start.

4. Leave a field blank rather than guessing a value if information is not yet available - blanks are easier to catch and correct later than wrong numbers.

4. Data Cleaning Standards

Apply the following checks before moving new data from the raw tab into the cleaned tab:

- Text casing: standardize Region, Sales Channel, Payment Method, and Order Status to Proper Case (e.g. ‘north’ - ‘North’).
- Customer Name: trim leading, trailing, and double spaces.
- Order Date: convert all entries to a single format (YYYY-MM-DD); manually verify any date where the format is ambiguous.
- Missing Quantity or Total Sales: recover using Total Sales = Quantity × Unit Price × (1 − Discount%) wherever the other two values are available; leave blank if not recoverable.
- Missing Discount %: leave blank rather than assuming 0%.

- Duplicates: check for and remove exact duplicate rows before finalizing the cleaned tab.
- Product and Product Category: match entries against the standard product list; use dropdown validation going forward to prevent new inconsistencies.
- Log every issue found and the action taken in the Data Summary tab, this is the evidence trail for this SOP and for the Executive Summary.

5. Updating the Pivot Summaries

- After cleaning, refresh the Region, Category, and Channel pivot tables to reflect the latest data (right-click any pivot table > Refresh, or Data > Refresh All).
- Confirm the Grand Total in each pivot matches the total row count and total revenue in the cleaned data tab before using the numbers in any report.

6. Updating the Monthly Trend & Forecast

- Add the newly completed month's actual total to the Monthly Trend & Forecast tab, extending the Month and Actual Total Sales columns.
- Update the sequence number column and shift the 3-month FORECAST formulas forward so they always project the next 3 months from the latest actual data.
- Re-check the forecast range against recent volatility before sharing it, flag it as a directional estimate if monthly totals continue to swing widely.

7. Updating the Power BI Dashboard

- Open the .pbix file and click Refresh on the Home tab to pull in the latest data from the Excel source.
- Confirm all three charts (Region, Category, Monthly Trend) and the slicer still update together correctly after the refresh.
- Republish or re-share the dashboard file only after confirming the refreshed numbers match the cleaned Excel data.

8. Review & Governance

- Review the full Retail Sales Record for data quality issues at the end of each month, before the new Executive Summary is prepared.
- Keep the raw data tab untouched as a permanent record; all cleaning happens on a working copy.
- Review this SOP itself periodically and update it as the reporting process evolves.